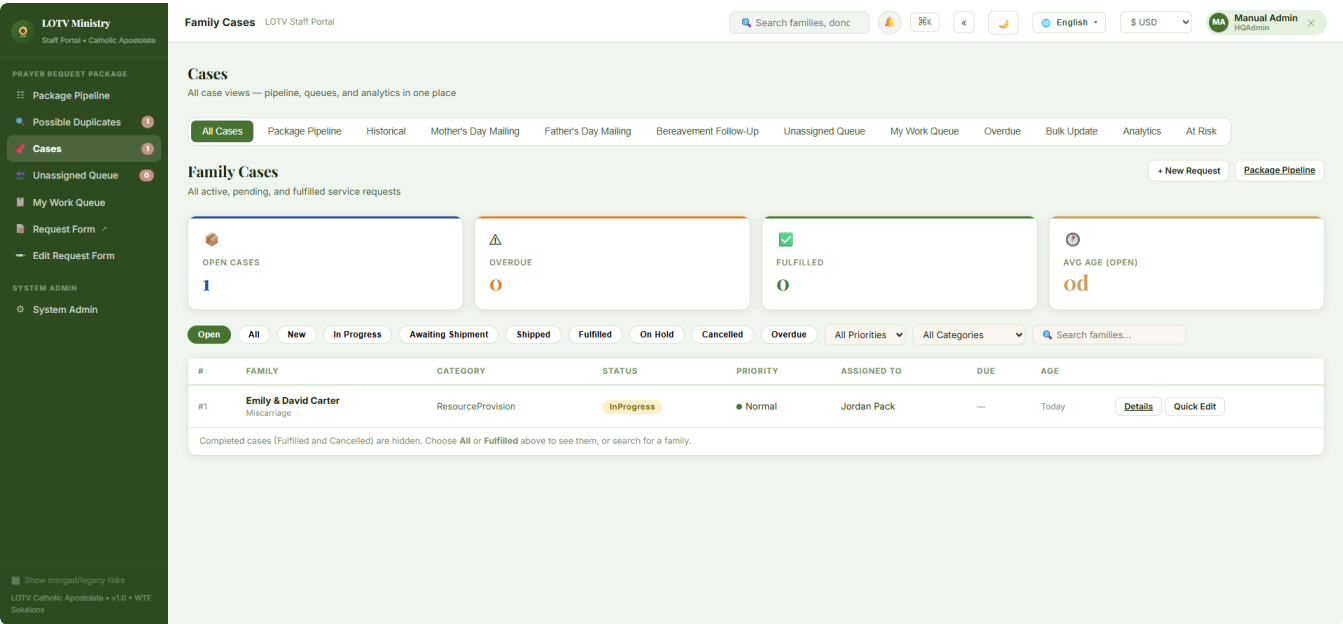


Staff Guide: The Cases Hub, Duplicates, and Queues

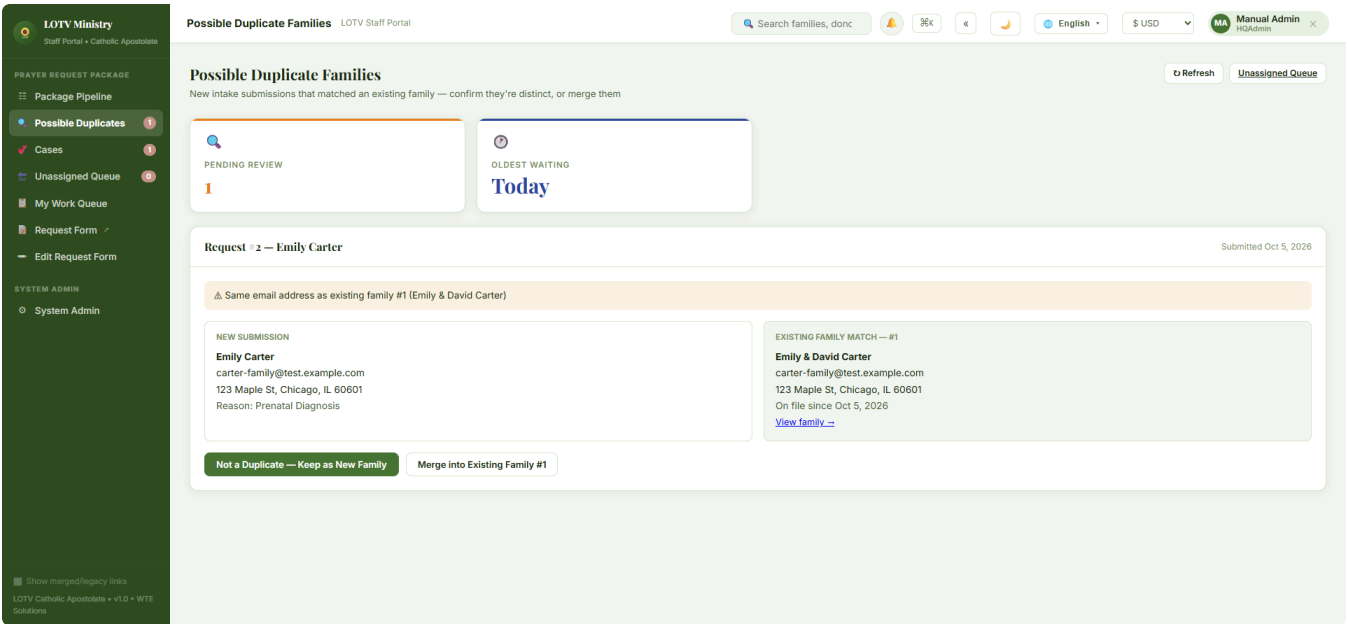
The Cases Hub

Open **Cases** at `/admin/cases-hub` — one page, 12 tabs, every way of looking at case data in one place. Each tab is the same page you'd reach individually elsewhere in the app; the Hub just puts them all behind one set of tab buttons.



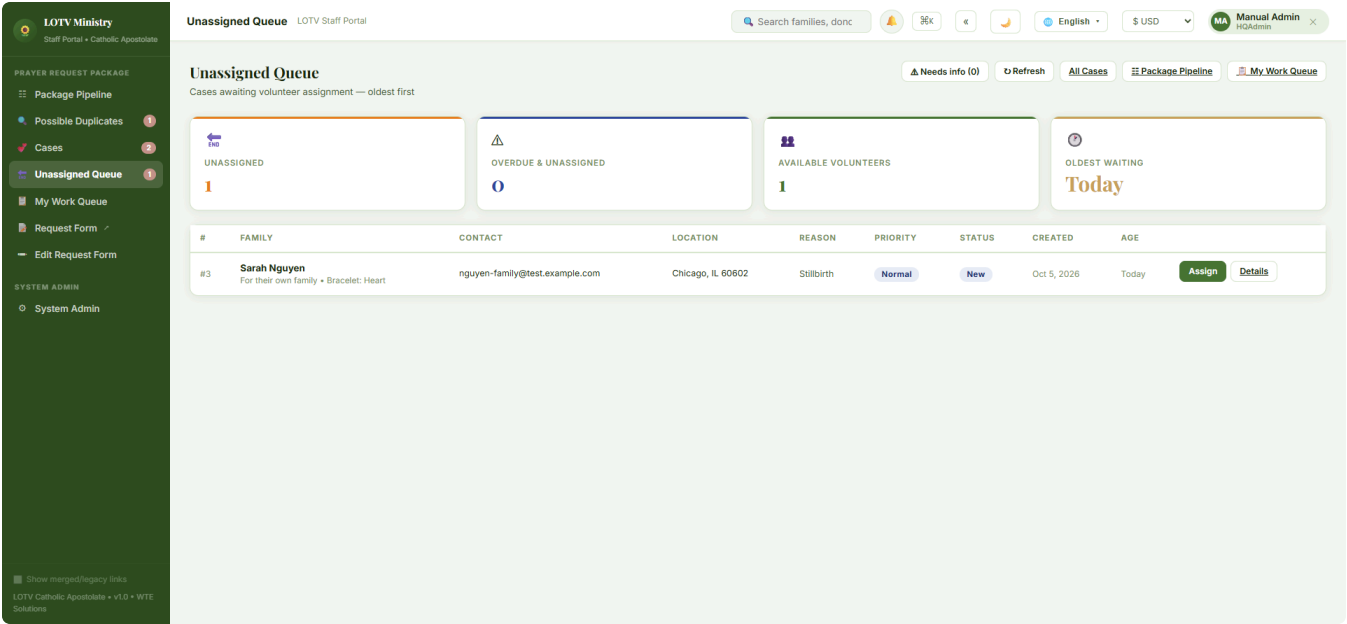
How a Possible Duplicate Gets Flagged

Open **Possible Duplicates** at `/admin/families/duplicate-review` — a sidebar link of its own, outside the Cases Hub tabs, with a live count badge.



The Unassigned Queue

Open **Unassigned Queue** at `/admin/queue` — every New case with nobody on it yet, oldest first, with KPIs for how many are unassigned, how many of those are overdue, how many volunteers are available, and the oldest wait time.



Assigning to yourself or to someone else

Click **Assign** on any case to open a drawer with the full family summary (contact, address, parish/diocese, faith tradition, date of loss) and:

- An **Assign To** dropdown listing every active volunteer, each with their current active-case count.
- Up to 5 **suggested volunteers ranked by workload** (a composite score) — click one to select it instantly.

There's no separate "assign to me" button — if you want a case for yourself, you pick your own name from the same dropdown everyone else uses. That only works once you have your own volunteer record (Package Assembler role); if you don't have one yet, create it first from **My Work Queue** ("Create my volunteer record"), then come back here and you'll appear in this same list.

Steps:

1. Click **Assign** next to the case.
2. Review the family summary that opens.
3. Pick a volunteer from the **Assign To** dropdown — or click one of the ranked suggestions to select it instantly. To take it yourself, pick your own name.
4. Click **Confirm Assignment**.

The screenshot shows the LOTV Ministry Staff Portal interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: PRAYER REQUEST PACKAGE, Package Pipeline, Possible Duplicates, Cases, Unassigned Queue (selected), My Work Queue, Request Form, Edit Request Form, SYSTEM ADMIN, and System Admin. The main content area is titled 'Unassigned Queue' and shows a table of cases awaiting volunteer assignment. The table has columns for #, FAMILY, CONTACT, LOCATION, REASON, PRIORITY, and STATUS. One case is listed: #3, Sarah Nguyen, For their own family • Bracelet: Heart, nguyen-family@test.example.com, Chicago, IL 60602, Stillbirth, Normal, and New. To the right of the table are three summary cards: UNASSIGNED (1), OVERDUE & UNASSIGNED (0), and AVAILABLE VOLUNTEERS (1). An 'Assign Case #3' modal is open on the right, displaying family details: Family: Sarah Nguyen, Email: nguyen-family@test.example.com, Phone: —, Address: 456 Oak Ave, Chicago, IL 60602, Parish / Diocese: — / —, Faith: Not specified, Date of loss: —, Requested for: Their own family, Reason: Stillbirth, Created: Oct 5, 2026 (Today old). Below the details is an 'ASSIGN TO' dropdown menu, a 'SUGGESTED (RANKED BY WORKLOAD)' section showing 'Jordan Pack — 74 pts' with a 'Select' button, and 'Confirm Assignment' and 'Cancel' buttons.

Then what?

Once assigned, the case moves to **My Work Queue** for whoever it's assigned to — see the [Volunteer Quick Guide: Packing & Shipping a Package](#) for what happens from there, and the [Staff Guide: The Package Pipeline Board](#) for the drag-and-drop view of the same case moving through its stages.

When someone submits the public request form, the system checks the new family against every existing family **in the same chapter**, in this order, and stops at the first hit:

1. **Same email address** as an existing family.
2. **Same phone number** (digits only — formatting doesn't matter).
3. **Same last name and ZIP code** together.

If any of those match, the new submission is held out of the Unassigned Queue, auto-assignment, and the Package Pipeline entirely — it waits here instead, and staff see exactly which rule matched (e.g. "Same email address as existing family #2").

Resolving one

Each possible duplicate shows the new submission side by side with the existing family it matched, plus two buttons:

- **Not a Duplicate — Keep as New Family** — confirms they're different people; the case then enters the normal pipeline (Unassigned Queue, auto-assignment, etc.) like any other.
- **Merge into Existing Family #X** — folds the new request into the existing family's record instead of creating a second one.

Until you choose one, the case sits here and nowhere else — it won't show up in the Unassigned Queue, Package Pipeline, or case counts.

How to resolve one, step by step:

1. Open **Possible Duplicates** — each entry shows the new submission next to the existing family it matched.
2. Read the match reason (e.g. "Same email address as existing family #2") and compare the two sides.
3. Decide: are these the same family, or genuinely different people?
4. Click **Not a Duplicate — Keep as New Family** if they're different (the case then enters the normal pipeline), or **Merge into Existing Family #X** if they're the same (the new request folds into that family's existing record).

That's it — no undo step, so take a moment on step 3 if you're not sure; when genuinely unsure, it's safer to click through to the existing family's record first (via the link on that side) to compare more history before deciding.

Tab	What it's for
All Cases	Every active, pending, and fulfilled request, with filters and search.
Package Pipeline	The drag-and-drop Kanban board (see the separate Package Pipeline Board guide).
Historical	Read-only archive of closed-out requests from prior years — not part of the active pipeline.
Mother's Day Mailing	One card per mother for the current Mother's Day cycle; everyone with a request since last Mother's Day is on the list automatically.
Father's Day Mailing	Same idea for Father's Day; families with no father on record are left off.
Bereavement Follow-Up	Stephen's Ministry-style touchpoints at 3 weeks, 3 months, 6 months, and 11 months after loss.
Unassigned Queue	Cases awaiting a volunteer — see below.
My Work Queue	Cases assigned to you (see the Volunteer Quick Guide: Packing & Shipping).
Overdue	Open requests past 7 days with no resolution.
Bulk Update	Select several cases and change their status or priority in one action.
Analytics	Every case-analytics cut in one place — heat map, reason breakdown, timing, intake trend, geography, overdue queue.
At Risk	Overdue, unassigned, stalled, and urgent cases needing attention, all in one list.

"New Case" isn't a tab — it's its own button/sidebar link, always one click away rather than buried behind a tab switch.